

TidyTuesday Week 38

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Tuesday 15th September, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only weekly newsletter brave enough to shove two economic time series into a blender and call whatever comes out "science." This week the random number gods handed us a truly enthralling slate: California house prices versus some discontinued corporate spending figures, and then, for variety, more California house prices versus a discontinued measure of prime-based bank loans. If you were hoping for a coherent theme, I have terrible news and also I have never once had a coherent theme.

Monday's pairing was Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura house prices against "financial business gross fixed investment on equipment, software, and structures," a series so discontinued it stopped reporting back in 2017 and clearly took its dignity with it. The raw regression came out swinging with an R-squared of 0.87 and a p-value with more zeros than my bank account, which, if you took it at face value, would suggest that Ventura County home values and corporate gizmo-buying are practically soulmates. Then we detrended it, stripped out the shared "everything got bigger over fifty years" drift, and watched that beautiful 0.87 faceplant down to 0.23. So no, they are not soulmates; they just both happened to march upward through the decades like everything else in a growing economy. Classic trend mirage. This is the exact flavor of statistical heartbreak this project exists to point and laugh at.

Tuesday somehow managed to be even less impressive, which I did not think was possible. San Luis Obispo house prices versus the thrilling "percent of value of loans prime based by average loan size" gave us a raw R-squared of 0.039 – yes, that is a three-point-nine percent, the statistical equivalent of a shrug – and a p-value of 0.076 that couldn't even clear the traditional bar for pretend-significance. Detrended, it got worse, flipping the sign and slumping to a p-value of 0.14. Two series that never really agreed on anything, and after removing their trends they agreed even less. Somewhere a residual is filing for emotional distress.

As always, the mandatory reminder that I am legally and morally obligated to repeat: these are randomly paired series, chosen by a script, with absolutely no theory, causation, or rigor behind them. When something looks strong here, the smart money is on coincidence and shared drift, not on a hidden truth about the economy. This week's lesson, in case Monday didn't make it obvious enough: an R-squared of 0.87 can crumble into rubble the second you ask it to explain itself. Spurious correlation isn't the exception around here – it's the whole business model.

2 Date: 2026-09-14

Series ID: ATNHPIUS37100Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura, CA (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1976-04-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 6.

Series ID: FBGFIEQ027S

This series is titled Financial business; gross fixed investment, nonresidential equipment, software, and structures, Flow (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate. The observation start date is 1946-10-01 and the observation end date is 2017-10-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FBGFIEQ027S	R-squared:	0.870			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.869			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1103.			
Date:	Mon, 14 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.84e-75			
Time:	17:07:08	Log-Likelihood:	-1926.0			
No. Observations:	167	AIC:	3856.			
Df Residuals:	165	BIC:	3862.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.341e+04	3837.676	3.493	0.001	5829.236	2.1e+04
value_fred_ATNHPIUS37100Q	745.7296	22.457	33.207	0.000	701.389	790.070
Omnibus:	1.131	Durbin-Watson:	0.039			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.568	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.803			
Skew:	-0.148	Prob(JB):	0.669			
Kurtosis:	3.165	Cond. No.	341.			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

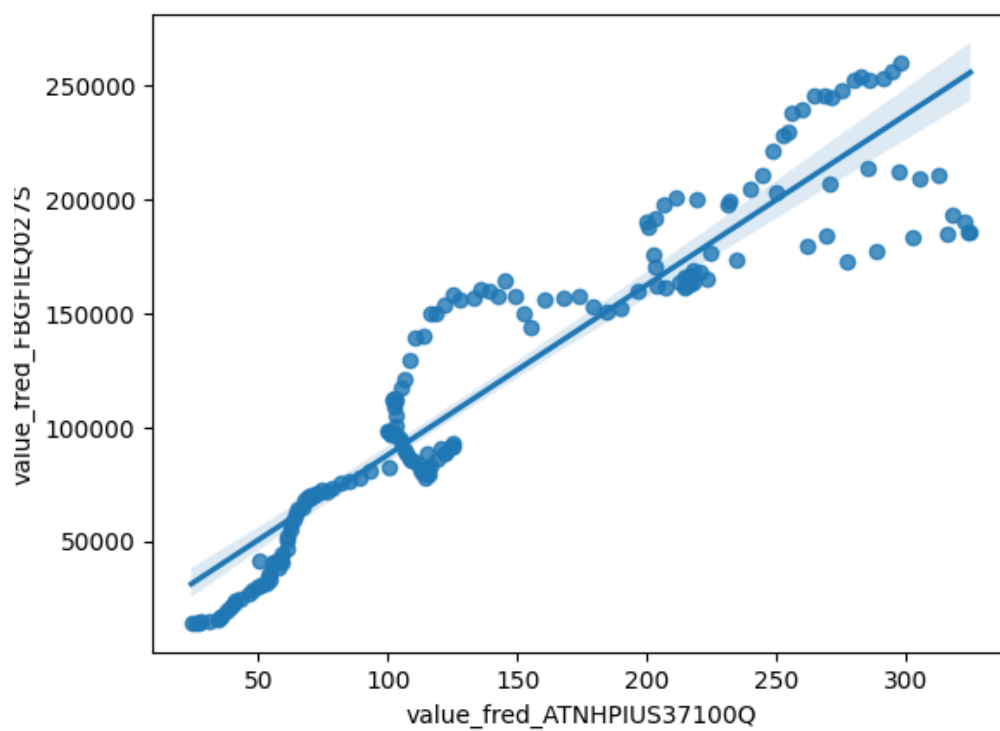


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-14

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FBGFIEQ027S_detrended	R-squared:	0.233
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.228
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	50.05
Date:	Mon, 14 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	4.06e-11
Time:	17:07:08	Log-Likelihood:	-1814.4
No. Observations:	167	AIC:	3633.
Df Residuals:	165	BIC:	3639.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.573e-09	985.135	-1.6e-12	1.000	-1945.095	1945.095
value_fred_ATNHPIUS37100Q_detrended	197.7479	27.952	7.075	0.000	142.559	252.937

Omnibus:	3.074	Durbin-Watson:	0.100
Prob(Omnibus):	0.215	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.616
Skew:	-0.248	Prob(JB):	0.270
Kurtosis:	3.361	Cond. No.	35.2

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

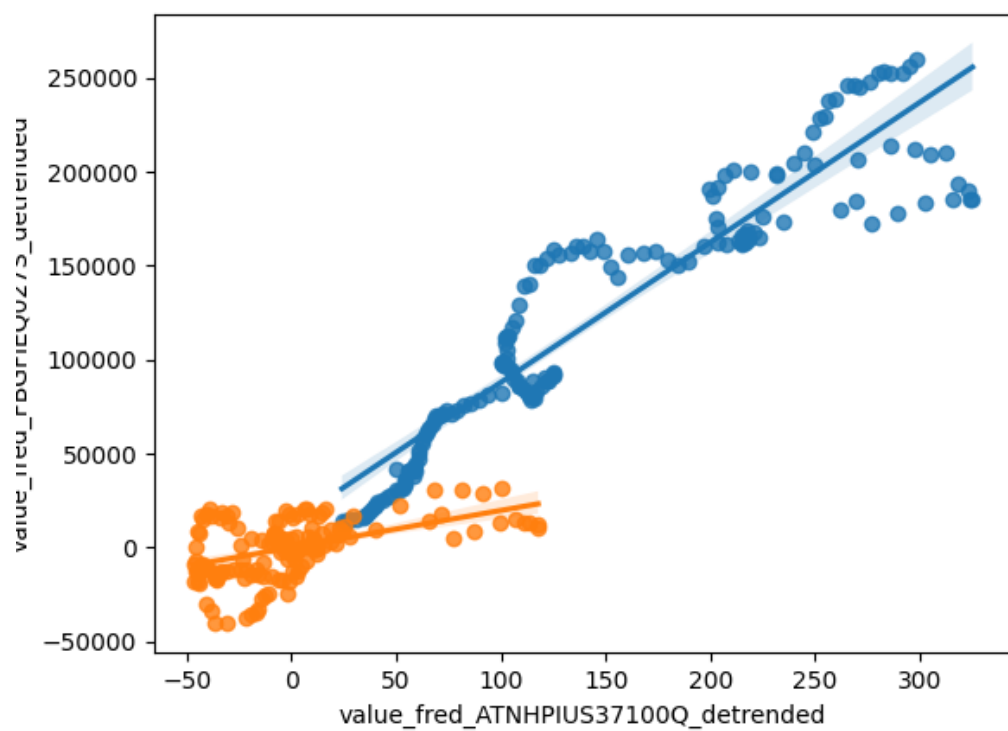


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-14

3 Date: 2026-09-15

Series ID: ATNHPIUS42020Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for San Luis Obispo-Paso Robles, CA (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1977-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 8.

Series ID: EARPRXDBNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Prime Based by Average Loan Size (\$ thousands), Prime, Domestic Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-04-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EARPRXDBNQ	R-squared:	0.039
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.027
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	3.241
Date:	Tue, 15 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0756
Time:	15:46:24	Log-Likelihood:	-364.17
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	732.3
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	737.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	176.5714	8.976	19.671	0.000	158.704	194.438
value_fred_ATNHPIUS42020Q	0.0686	0.038	1.800	0.076	-0.007	0.144

Omnibus:	0.239	Durbin-Watson:	1.271
Prob(Omnibus):	0.887	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.081
Skew:	-0.077	Prob(JB):	0.960
Kurtosis:	3.017	Cond. No.	866.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EARPRXDBNQ_detrended	R-squared:	0.027
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.015
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.188
Date:	Tue, 15 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.143
Time:	15:46:25	Log-Likelihood:	-356.02
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	716.0
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	720.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-4.581e-12	2.207	-2.08e-12	1.000	-4.393	4.393
value_fred_ATNHPIUS42020Q_detrended	-0.0708	0.048	-1.479	0.143	-0.166	0.024

Omnibus:	1.694	Durbin-Watson:	1.556
Prob(Omnibus):	0.429	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.096
Skew:	0.241	Prob(JB):	0.578
Kurtosis:	3.303	Cond. No.	46.1

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

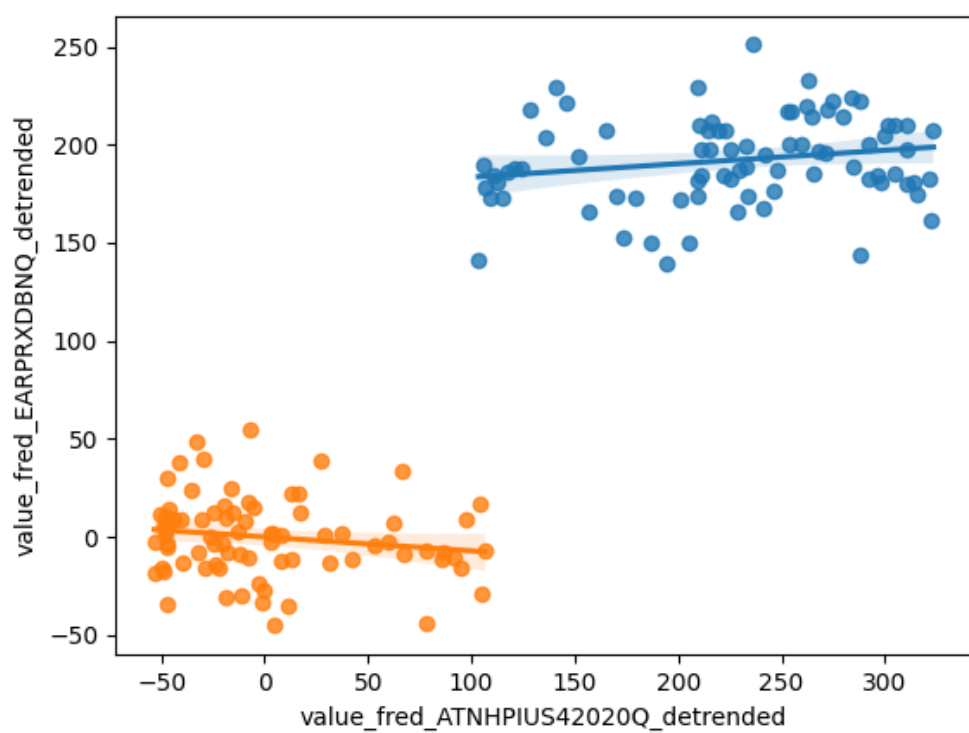


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-15